Extract Five: *The following cable was written shortly after a devastating earthquake in Haiti, in early 2010.*

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Created: Feb 26, 2010 18:34
SUBJECT: APPAREL SECTOR HIGHLIGHTS HAITI'S ECONOMIC RESILIENCE AND POTENTIAL

1. (SBU) Within two weeks of the January 12 earthquake, Haiti's garment manufacturing sector resumed exports to the US, re-routing shipments through Dominican ports. Prior to the earthquake, apparel assembled in Haiti accounted for three-quarters of the country's exports, employing one-fifth of the formal sector. Of the eighteen garment manufacturers in Port au Prince, two must relocate and rebuild from the ground up; one factory that completely collapsed crushed hundreds of workers inside, at least 300 of whom did not survive. Despite the loss of workers and limited access to basic resources, including electricity, many factories have reopened, simultaneously undertaking minor to moderate repairs, clean-up, and reconstruction. Shipping from Haiti resumed in less than a month, meeting customers' expectations of having their orders filled on time. Logistics constraints, while not wholly solved, have been overcome more quickly than expected, and increased international support for the industry aims to create more jobs and bolster the Haitian economy.

2. (SBU) International investors, brands, and manufacturers who expressed interest in expanding production in Haiti before the earthquake renewed their commitment to support the Haitian apparel industry, taking advantage of the trade preferences of the HOPE II Act for duty-free export to the US (reftel A). At the apparel industry's largest trade show in Las Vegas in February, the US Trade Representative (USTR), along with Gap Inc., Hanes Brands, and the US Association of Importers of Textiles and Apparels announced the Plus One for Haiti initiative, urging clothing retailers to "buy Haitian" and source at least one percent of their total apparel production from Haiti. Representatives from the GOH Presidential Commission for the Implementation of HOPE (CTMO-HOPE) are currently in Washington working with USTR on an additional HOPE extension.